

Fig 11.17: Food Sources of Vitamin B_{12}

DO YOU KNOW...?

To prevent anaemia, two factors are required: an intrinsic factor produced by gastric parietal cells and the extrinsic factor of vitamin B_{12}.

11.3.7 Vitamin C

Vitamin C is also known as ascorbic acid. It is an antioxidant and a water soluble vitamin. It is destroyed by light, heat and when exposed to air and metals. During cooking much of it is destroyed. Iron and copper act as catalysts and cooking in these vessels increases the loss of vitamin C. When the vegetables are cut into fine pieces more enzymes are released and it causes more loss. Vitamin C is essential in cholesterol metabolism.

Functions:

- It is helpful in the formation of collagen, the cementing material between cells that holds them together.
- Vitamin C builds up natural body defence and helps provide immunity to the body.
- It helps the body to absorb more iron from plant sources.
- It aids in the healing of wounds.
- It helps to keep gums healthy.
- It helps body to fight infections.
- Improves bone formation.
- It prevents the deposition of cholesterol on the walls of the arteries and prevents heart diseases.

UNIT-11_174-207.indd 188 23-01-2020 10:18:36